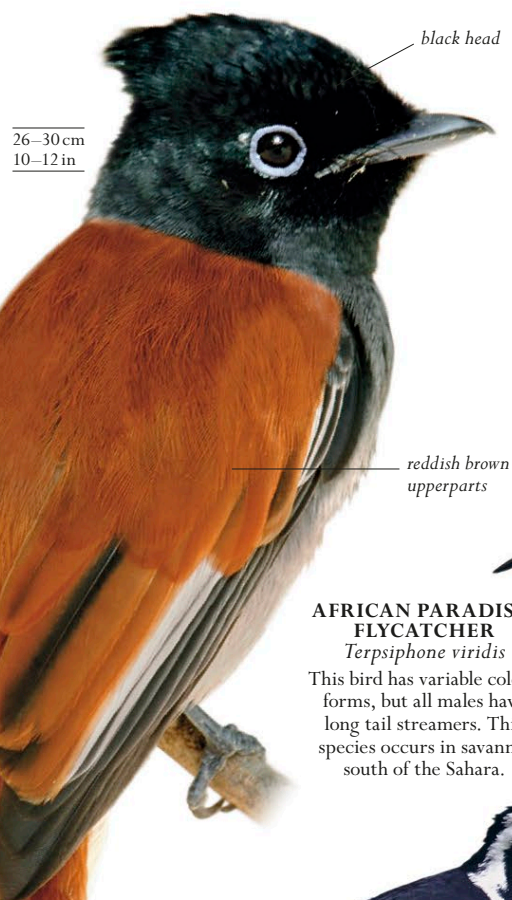


MONARCHS AND RELATIVES

Generally long-tailed birds, members of the Monarchidae have a broad bill for fly-catching. Most species occur in Old World tropical forests. With the exception of the magpie-lark, they are tree-dwellers that build cup-shaped nests decorated with lichen.



26–30 cm
10–12 in

black head

reddish brown
upperparts

AFRICAN PARADISE-FLYCATCHER *Terpsiphone viridis*

This bird has variable colour forms, but all males have long tail streamers. This species occurs in savanna, south of the Sahara.



17–38 cm
6½–15 in

long
tail
feather

MAGPIE-LARK *Grallina cyanoleuca*

Unlike other members of the monarch family, this Australian bird spends much time on the ground and builds a large mud nest.

SWALLOWS AND MARTINS

From the family Hirundinidae, these swift-like birds have long wings and a forked tail. Their short, flattened bill and wide gape help in taking insects on the wing. They build mud nests or use tree-holes or tunnels in banks.



GREATER STRIPED SWALLOW *Cecropis cucullata*

This African grassland swallow breeds towards the south of the continent and migrates northwards to overwinter.

AUSTRALIAN MUDNESTERS

The family Corcoracidae contains two species of social birds that feed on the ground and build large, cup-shaped nests of grass. These are held together with mud and are made in trees on horizontal branches.



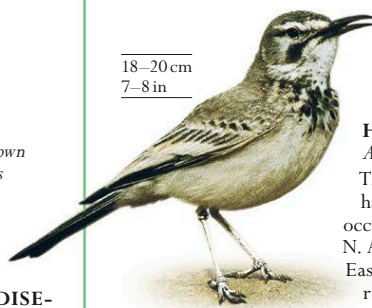
APOSTLEBIRD *Struthidea cinerea*

This ground-living bird associates in flocks of 6 to 20 individuals. It occurs in woodlands of northern and E. Australia.

29–32 cm
11½–12½ in

LARKS

Brown in colour, with a melodious call, these birds from the family Alaudidae inhabit arid, open habitats. Most occur in Africa, with one species in North America. They usually have long hind claws that provide the stability they need to spend so much time on the ground.



18–20 cm
7–8 in

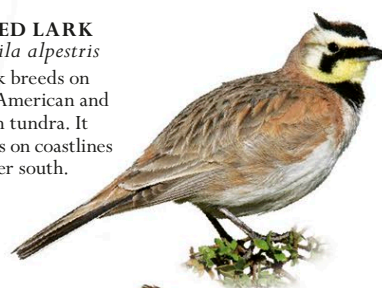
GREATER HOOPOE-LARK *Alaemon alaudipes*

This long-legged lark has a curved bill and occurs in arid habitats of N. Africa and the Middle East, where it habitually runs on the ground.

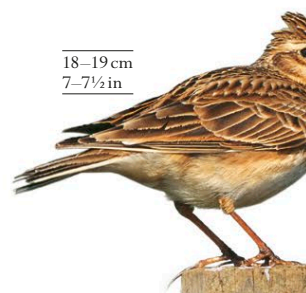
HORNED LARK *Eremophila alpestris*

This lark breeds on Arctic N. American and Eurasian tundra. It overwinters on coastlines further south.

14–17 cm
5½–6½ in



18–19 cm
7–7½ in



EURASIAN SKYLARK *Alauda arvensis*

Common across Eurasia, from the British Isles to Japan, this open-country bird is notable for its musical aerial song.

BULBULS

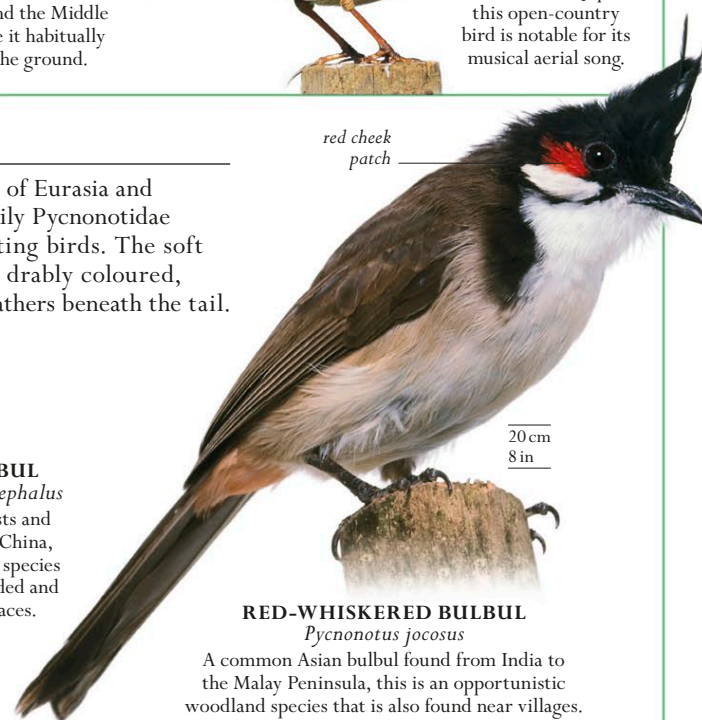
Found across the warmer parts of Eurasia and Africa, most bulbuls of the family Pycnonotidae are gregarious, noisy, fruit-eating birds. The soft plumage of many species is drably coloured, marked by red or yellow feathers beneath the tail.



23–25 cm
9–10 in

BLACK BULBUL *Hypsipetes leucocephalus*

Common in forests and gardens in India, China, and Thailand, this species exists in dark-headed and white-headed races.

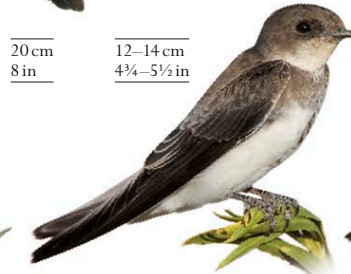


red cheek
patch

20 cm
8 in

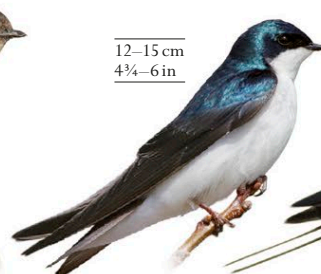
RED-WHISKERED BULBUL *Pycnonotus jocosus*

A common Asian bulbul found from India to the Malay Peninsula, this is an opportunistic woodland species that is also found near villages.



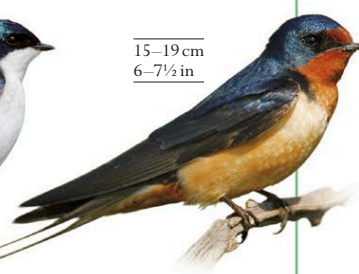
COLLARED SAND MARTIN *Riparia riparia*

Like other swallows, this species migrates south to overwinter in the tropics. It nests in colonies in riverside banks across the northern hemisphere.



TREE SWALLOW *Tachycineta bicolor*

This N. American swallow of wooded swamps supplements its insect diet with berries. This enables it to breed further north than other swallows.



BARN SWALLOW *Hirundo rustica*

Occurring worldwide, this is the most widespread species of swallow. It was originally a cave-nester, but now uses buildings as well.